

Hao Yu

PhD researcher in Engineering | University of Cambridge

hy377@cam.ac.uk | Cambridge, United Kingdom

Website | ORCID: 0000-0003-1722-7909 | GitHub: barry063

Research profile

I study how precursor chemistry and confined vapour transport shape low-dimensional materials. My work connects close-space growth experiments with Raman and photoluminescence spectroscopy, collaborative characterisation, and Python analysis.

Education

University of Cambridge · PhD in Engineering | Oct 2022 - present

Thesis submitted 30 September 2026.

Close-space sublimation as a platform for accelerated process discovery in low-dimensional material growth.

Hofmann Group, Department of Engineering. Supervisor: Professor Stephan Hofmann.

University of Oxford · MEng in Materials Science | Oct 2018 - Jul 2022

Trinity College. Research project on photonic micro-ring resonator tuning.

Selected research contributions

Close-space growth of tungsten oxide and sulphide nanostructures | Feb 2023 - Jan 2025

I designed and conducted CSS-facilitated CVD growth and Raman/PL measurements, and co-wrote the first-author paper with Stephan Hofmann. The study connects precursor delivery and growth conditions with material formation. Operando SEM, TEM/EDX and XPS measurements in this study were performed by collaborators.

NaCl-assisted close-space growth of WS₂ | Jun 2025 - Apr 2026

I investigated salt-assisted close-space growth using paired source-substrate analysis and Raman/PL measurements to examine precursor evolution alongside deposition outcomes. This work forms part of my submitted thesis; a first-author manuscript is in preparation.

Optical characterisation of directly written MoS₂ | Jun - Aug 2025

I contributed Raman and photoluminescence measurements and analysis to a collaborative closed-loop crystal-layer writing study. The growth platform and complementary measurements were led by other co-authors. The co-authored manuscript is under review.

RamanPL_2D | Research software

I developed a Python toolkit for Raman and photoluminescence preprocessing, peak fitting, spatial mapping, batch workflows and metadata-aware export.

Photonic resonance trimming | Sep 2021 - Jun 2022

My MEng research concerned micro-ring resonator tuning. I contributed measurements, design and simulations to the subsequent Nano Letters paper on photonic-resonance trimming.

Research outputs

Published journal articles

Hao Yu et al. (first author). A close-space sublimation approach to tungsten oxide and sulfide nanostructure formation. *Nanoscale* 17(36), 21070-21082. (2025).

First author. Designed and conducted CSS-CVD growth and Raman/PL measurements; co-wrote the manuscript with Stephan Hofmann.

[10.1039/D5NR01458A](https://doi.org/10.1039/D5NR01458A)

Sunvir Sahota et al., including Hao Yu. Se nanowire crystal formation via oxidation of 2D HfSe₂: A solid-state, in situ reaction coupling for heterogeneous integration technologies. *ACS Applied Nano Materials* 8(15), 7608-7615. (2025).

Co-author. Raman and SEM data acquisition and analysis.

[10.1021/acsanm.5c00308](https://doi.org/10.1021/acsanm.5c00308)

Nikolaos Farmakidis, Hao Yu et al. (second author). Scalable high-precision trimming of photonic resonances by polymer exposure to energetic beams. *Nano Letters* 23(11), 4800-4806. (2023).

Second author. Measurements, design and simulations. Associated correction: *Nano Letters* 24(41), 13103-13104 (2024).

[10.1021/acs.nanolett.3c00220](https://doi.org/10.1021/acs.nanolett.3c00220)

Associated correction: [10.1021/acs.nanolett.4c03363](https://doi.org/10.1021/acs.nanolett.4c03363)

Minfei Jian et al., including Hao Yu. How do microplastics adsorb metals? A preliminary study under simulated wetland conditions. *Chemosphere* 309, Part 1, 136547. (2022).

Co-author. Published CRediT contribution: data analysis.

[10.1016/j.chemosphere.2022.136547](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chemosphere.2022.136547)

Under review: Closed-loop crystal layer writing of atomically thin semiconductor

Co-authored manuscript. Contribution: Raman/PL measurements and analysis.

In preparation: Salt-assisted close-space growth of monolayer WS₂

First-author manuscript in preparation on source-transport-growth relationships. Topic description; final title to follow.

Research software: RamanPL_2D

Python toolkit for Raman/PL preprocessing, peak fitting, spatial mapping, batch workflows and metadata-aware export. BSD 3-Clause License.

Experience

Investment Analyst Intern · InnoAngel Fund | Jun - Aug 2026

Completed the Little Angel Programme, with experience in early-stage deep-tech investment, sector research and technology assessment. Conducted compute-in-memory chip sector research covering technical routes, value chains and application scenarios.

EnterpriseTECH Analyst · Cambridge Judge Business School | Jan - Apr 2026

Conducted market sizing, application analysis and competitor mapping for photonic photovoltaic technology targeting indoor solar and ambient IoT. Supported a TRL 2-to-TRL 4 roadmap and IP licensing strategy, including MVP and scale-up considerations.

School Ambassador · BOE Technology Group | Jan 2023 - Dec 2025

Organised online and in-person career events at UK universities and identified potential research collaborators for MicroLED technology.

Selected honours and funding

Cambridge Philosophical Society Studentship | 2025-2026

Exhibition Scholar · Trinity College, Oxford | 2020-2022

Singapore Ministry of Education SM1 scholarship | 2014-2017